Linux gets a preview of Microsoft's Azure Container Instances

Microsoft is adding a new service to its cloud portfolio dubbed Azure Container Instances. While the development is yet to receive Windows support, a public preview for Linux containers is out to help developers create and deploy containers without the hassle of managing virtual machines.

Microsoft claims that Azure Container Instances (ACI) takes only a few seconds to start. The configuration window is highly customisable. Also, users simply need to select the exact memory and count of CPUs that they need.

Designed to work with Docker and Kubernetes, the new service allows developers to utilise container instances and virtual machines simultaneously in the same cluster. Microsoft is also releasing ACI connector for Kubernetes to help the deployment of clusters to ACIs.

"While Azure Container Instances are not orchestrators and are not intended to replace them, they will fuel orchestrators and other services as a container building block," said Corey Sanders, director of compute, Azure, in a statement.

The company executives are hoping that ACIs will be used for fast bursting and scaling. Virtual machines can be deployed alongside the cloud to deliver predictable scaling so that workloads can migrate back and forth between two infrastructure models.

Windows support for ACI is likely to be released in the coming weeks. In the meantime, you can test it on your Linux container system.

as plain text. This allows them to create custom watermarks for their documents. Additionally, a new context menu is available to help users with footnotes, endnotes, styles and sections.

The new version of Calc has support for pivot charts. Users can customise pivot tables and comment via menu commands. Impress helps users in specifying fractional angles while duplicating objects. There is also an auto save feature for settings to help in duplicating an operation. This is a part of Calc as well as Impress.

LibreOffice 5.4 is available for download for Mac OS, Linux and Windows through its official website. The organisation has also improved the LibreOffice online package with better performance and a more responsive layout. You can access the latest LibreOffice source code as Docker images.

OpenSUSE Leap 42.3 is out with new KDE Plasma and GNOME versions

OpenSUSE has released the new version of its Leap distribution. Debuted as OpenSUSE Leap 42.3, the new release is based on SUSE Linux Enterprise (SLE) 12 Service Pack 3.

The new update includes hundreds of updated packages. There is the new SUSE version that is powered by Linux kernel 4.4. The development team has spent a good eight months in producing this rock-solid Leap build.

The most notable addition in OpenSUSE Leap 42.3 is the KDE Plasma 5.8 LTS desktop environment. Users have the option to either pick the latest KDE version or go with GNOME 3.20. There is also a provision to install other supported environments.

Apart from the new desktop environment options, the OpenSUSE Leap update comes with a server installation profile and includes a full-featured text mode installer. The platform also officially supports Open-Channel solid-state drives through the LightNVM full-stack initiative. Likewise, there are numerous architectural improvements for 64-bit ARM systems.

The OpenSUSE team has provided PHP5 and PHP7 support in the latest Leap distro. There is also an updated graphics stack based on Mesa 17, and GCC 4.8.5 as a default compiler. Considering the list of new changes, OpenSUSE 42.3 appears to be an advanced Linux version. It also comes preloaded with packages for streaming media, editing graphics, creating animation, playing games and building 3D printing projects.

The new OpenSUSE Leap version is available for download for both 32-bit and 64-bit systems. Existing OpenSUSE Leap users can upgrade their systems using the built-in update system.

Google blocks Android spyware family Lipizzan

Google's Android Security and Threat Analysis teams have jointly discovered a new spyware family that gets distributed through various channels including Play Store. Called Lipizzan, the software has been detected in 20 apps that have been downloaded on fewer than 100 devices.

Unlike some of the earlier spyware, Lipizzan is a multi-stage spyware that can be used to monitor and exfiltrate email, text messages, location, voice calls and media. It